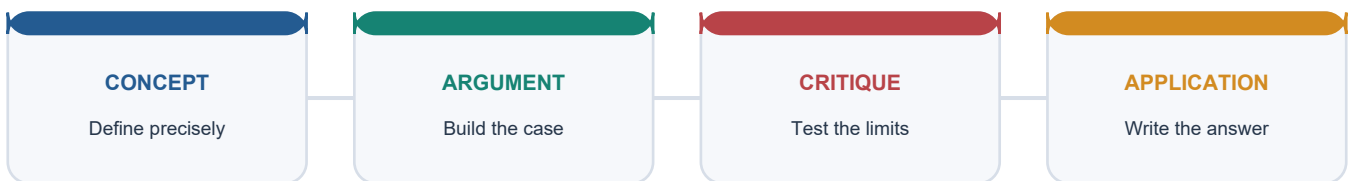


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Liberalism and Neoliberalism - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Liberalism and Neoliberalism - Solved Practice Workbook	4
--	----------

WORKBOOK GUIDE	4
-----------------------	----------

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	4
---------------------------------	----------

Practice design	4
MCQ 1	4
MCQ 2	5
MCQ 3	5
MCQ 4	6
MCQ 5	6
MCQ 6	7
MCQ 7	7
MCQ 8	8
MCQ 9	8
MCQ 10	9
MCQ 11	9
MCQ 12	10
MCQ 13	10
MCQ 14	11
MCQ 15	11
MCQ 16	12
MCQ 17	12
MCQ 18	13
MCQ 19	13
MCQ 20	14
MCQ 21	14
MCQ 22	15
MCQ 23	15
MCQ 24	16
MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL	16

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL	17
MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL	17
MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL	18
MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL	18
MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL	19
MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL	19
MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL	20
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	20
VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS	20
ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS	20
Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks	20
Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks	21
Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks	21
Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks	22
Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks	22
Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks	23

Liberalism and Neoliberalism - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 03 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Authoritarian state**?

- A. A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gaub, PDF p.40).
- B. The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gaub, PDF p.41).
- C. Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism (Gaub, PDF p.41).
- D. Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Authoritarian state.
- **B:** B Attaches to Welfare / positive liberalism, not Authoritarian state.
- **C:** C Attaches to John Locke, not Authoritarian state.
- **D:** D Attaches to Jeremy Bentham, not Authoritarian state.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Authoritarian state by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Classical / negative liberalism**?

- A. Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gaub, PDF pp.40-41).
- B. The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gaub, PDF p.41).
- C. Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for welfare and a positive state role (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42).
- D. A political principle that places liberty of the individual at the centre of public policy, especially freedom from authoritarian restraint

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Liberalism vs authoritarianism, not Classical / negative liberalism.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Classical / negative liberalism.
- **C:** C Attaches to J.S. Mill, not Classical / negative liberalism.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Classical / negative liberalism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Welfare / positive liberalism**?

- A. A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gaub, PDF p.40).
- B. Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism (Gaub, PDF p.41).
- C. The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gaub, PDF p.41).
- D. Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Authoritarian state, not Welfare / positive liberalism.
- **B:** B Attaches to John Locke, not Welfare / positive liberalism.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Welfare / positive liberalism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Jeremy Bentham, not Welfare / positive liberalism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Welfare / positive liberalism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Welfare state**?

- A. The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gaub, PDF p.41).
- B. A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gaub, PDF p.40).
- C. Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism (Gaub, PDF p.41).
- D. A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being (Gaub, PDF p.41).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Welfare / positive liberalism, not Welfare state.
- **B:** B Attaches to Authoritarian state, not Welfare state.
- **C:** C Attaches to John Locke, not Welfare state.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Welfare state.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Welfare state by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism**?

- A. Gauba groups these closely as a restoration of laissez-faire and welfare-state rollback. For conceptual precision, market neoliberalism (Hayek/Friedman) and rights-based libertarianism (Nozick) overlap but are not identical
- B. Hayek and Friedman chiefly defend market coordination and limits on welfare intervention; Nozick grounds a minimal state in self-ownership and entitlement. The labels may overlap in Gauba, but the arguments should not be treated as interchangeable
- C. on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without.
- D. Early liberal thought develops both through rights-bearing individualism and through happiness-maximizing utilitarianism, though Mill pulls utilitarianism toward liberty and welfare reform

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Neoliberalism vs libertarianism, not Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Coercion argument, not Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Individualism vs utilitarianism, not Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Liberalism vs authoritarianism**?

- A. Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for welfare and a positive state role (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42).
- B. Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gaub, PDF pp.40-41).
- C. The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gaub, PDF p.41).
- D. A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to J.S. Mill, not Liberalism vs authoritarianism.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Liberalism vs authoritarianism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Classical / negative liberalism, not Liberalism vs authoritarianism.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Liberalism vs authoritarianism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Classical vs welfare liberalism**?

- A. Welfare liberalism expands state responsibility; neoliberalism wants to roll back intervention and restore laissez-faire individualism (Gaub, PDF pp.42-43).
- B. Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for welfare and a positive state role (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42).
- C. Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42).
- D. The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gaub, PDF p.41).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism, not Classical vs welfare liberalism.
- **B:** B Attaches to J.S. Mill, not Classical vs welfare liberalism.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Classical vs welfare liberalism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Classical / negative liberalism, not Classical vs welfare liberalism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Classical vs welfare liberalism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism**?

- A. Gauba says liberalism today is invoked both as a theory of capitalism and as a theory of constitutionalism; the second has more lasting political value
- B. Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).
- C. Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for welfare and a positive state role (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).
- D. Welfare liberalism expands state responsibility; neoliberalism wants to roll back intervention and restore laissez-faire individualism (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Capitalism vs constitutionalism, not Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Classical vs welfare liberalism, not Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism.
- **C:** C Attaches to J.S. Mill, not Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Individualism vs utilitarianism - Early liberal thought develops both through rights-bearing individualism and through happiness-maximizing utilitarianism, though Mill pulls utilitarianism toward liberty and welfare reform
- B. "Critically evaluate" - Hayek and Friedman chiefly defend market coordination and limits on welfare intervention; Nozick grounds a minimal state in self-ownership and entitlement. The labels may overlap in Gauba, but the arguments should not be treated as interchangeable
- C. Capitalism vs constitutionalism - on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion.
- D. Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism - Welfare liberalism expands state responsibility; neoliberalism wants to roll back intervention and restore laissez-faire individualism

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Exact pair: Individualism vs utilitarianism is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Mismatched: Capitalism vs constitutionalism is recorded with Gauba says liberalism today is invoked both as a theory of capitalism and as a theory of constitutionalism; the second has more lasting political value (Gauba, PDF p.45).
- **D:** D Mismatched: Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism is recorded with Gauba groups these closely as a restoration of laissez-faire and welfare-state rollback (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). For conceptual precision, market neoliberalism (Hayek/Friedman) and rights-based libertarianism (Nozick) overlap but are not identical.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Individualism vs utilitarianism; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development
- B. Capitalism vs constitutionalism - Gauba says liberalism today is invoked both as a theory of capitalism and as a theory of constitutionalism; the second has more lasting political value
- C. Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism - The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gauba, PDF p.41).
- D. Classical vs welfare liberalism - Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gauba, PDF pp.40-41).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Exact pair: Capitalism vs constitutionalism is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Mismatched: Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism is recorded with Welfare liberalism expands state responsibility; neoliberalism wants to roll back intervention and restore laissez-faire individualism (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).
- **D:** D Mismatched: Classical vs welfare liberalism is recorded with Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Capitalism vs constitutionalism; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Individualism vs utilitarianism - Gauba says liberalism today is invoked both as a theory of capitalism and as a theory of constitutionalism; the second has more lasting political value
- B. Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism - the neoliberal claim is that decentralized market exchange coordinates dispersed knowledge and.
- C. Neoliberalism vs libertarianism - Hayek and Friedman chiefly defend market coordination and limits on welfare intervention; Nozick grounds a minimal state in self-ownership and entitlement. The labels may overlap in Gauba, but the arguments should not be treated as interchangeable
- D. Coercion argument - Give a reasoned verdict on whether liberalism's economic program (classical vs welfare vs neoliberal) or its constitutional core (Section 9).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Individualism vs utilitarianism is recorded with Early liberal thought develops both through rights-bearing individualism and through happiness-maximizing utilitarianism, though Mill pulls utilitarianism toward liberty and welfare reform (Gauba, PDF p.42).
- **B:** B Mismatched: Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism is recorded with Gauba groups these closely as a restoration of laissez-faire and welfare-state rollback (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). For conceptual precision, market neoliberalism (Hayek/Friedman) and rights-based libertarianism (Nozick) overlap but are not identical.
- **C:** C Exact pair: Neoliberalism vs libertarianism is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Coercion argument is recorded with on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without reliably satisfying genuine wants, even when it is intended to enlarge welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Neoliberalism vs libertarianism; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services
- B. Welfare / positive liberalism - A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being (Gaubu, PDF p.41).
- C. Jeremy Bentham - Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gaubu, PDF pp.40-41).
- D. John Locke - Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism (Gaubu, PDF p.41).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Authoritarian state is recorded with A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gaubu, PDF p.40).
- **B:** B Mismatched: Welfare / positive liberalism is recorded with The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gaubu, PDF p.41).
- **C:** C Mismatched: Jeremy Bentham is recorded with Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42).
- **D:** D Exact pair: John Locke is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to John Locke; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Adam Smith - Early liberal defender of laissez-faire and market society (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42).
- B. T.H. Green - Chief exponents of neoliberal or libertarian rollback against the welfare state (Gaubu, PDF p.42).
- C. Liberalism - A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge
- D. Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney - The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Exact pair: Adam Smith is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: T.H. Green is recorded with Adds a moral dimension and advances a fuller theory of welfare liberalism (Gaubu, PDF p.41).
- **C:** C Not this pair: Liberalism is recorded with a political principle that places liberty of the individual at the centre of public policy, especially freedom from authoritarian restraint.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney is recorded with Develop the welfare-state tradition in the first half of the twentieth century (Gaubu, PDF p.41).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Adam Smith; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Gauba groups these closely as a restoration of laissez-faire and welfare-state rollback. For conceptual precision, market neoliberalism (Hayek/Friedman) and rights-based libertarianism (Nozick) overlap but are not identical
- B. Jeremy Bentham - Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).
- C. Welfare / positive liberalism - A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being (Gauba, PDF p.41).
- D. Authoritarian state - Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gauba, PDF pp.40-41).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: John Locke is recorded with Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism (Gauba, PDF p.41).
- **B:** B Exact pair: Jeremy Bentham is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Mismatched: Welfare / positive liberalism is recorded with The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gauba, PDF p.41).
- **D:** D Mismatched: Authoritarian state is recorded with A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gauba, PDF p.40).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Jeremy Bentham; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Classical / negative liberalism - A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being
- B. Liberalism vs authoritarianism - Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare
- C. J.S. Mill - Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for welfare and a positive state role (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).
- D. Organization of the state according to a constitution so that power is structured and limited rather than arbitrary

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Classical / negative liberalism is recorded with The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gauba, PDF p.41).
- **B:** B Mismatched: Liberalism vs authoritarianism is recorded with Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gauba, PDF pp.40-41).
- **C:** C Exact pair: J.S. Mill is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Misplaced: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to J.S. Mill; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Adam Smith - The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development
- B. A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being
- C. Hayek / Friedman / Nozick - Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development
- D. T.H. Green - Adds a moral dimension and advances a fuller theory of welfare liberalism (Gaub, PDF p.41).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Adam Smith is recorded with Early liberal defender of laissez-faire and market society (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42).
- **B:** B Mismatched: Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney is recorded with Develop the welfare-state tradition in the first half of the twentieth century (Gaub, PDF p.41).
- **C:** C Mismatched: Hayek / Friedman / Nozick is recorded with Chief exponents of neoliberal or libertarian rollback against the welfare state (Gaub, PDF p.42).
- **D:** D Exact pair: T.H. Green is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to T.H. Green; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney** is associated with: Develop the welfare-state tradition in the first half of the twentieth century (Gaub, PDF p.41).
2. **Price/market-coordination argument** is associated with: Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (Section 21).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Hayek / Friedman / Nozick** is associated with: on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without reliably satisfying genuine wants, even when it is intended to enlarge welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).
2. **Coercion argument** is associated with: on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without reliably satisfying genuine wants, even when it is intended to enlarge welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Hayek / Friedman / Nozick does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Knowledge argument** is associated with: neoliberalism holds that governments cannot possess sufficient knowledge of dispersed individual needs and circumstances to plan an economy successfully; needs and coordination emerge instead through unpredictable transactions in a free market ("spontaneous order"), not through centralized state knowledge (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).
2. **"Examine"/"Critically examine"** is associated with: Test Hayek's knowledge/price/coercion arguments (Section 13) and Nozick's entitlement theory (Section 14) against the Rawlsian/welfare reply (Section 15).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Knowledge argument does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Price/market-coordination argument** is associated with: Give a reasoned verdict on whether liberalism's economic program (classical vs welfare vs neoliberal) or its constitutional core (Section 9, Section 19 Unit 6) is its more defensible contribution.
2. **"Critically evaluate"** is associated with: The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gaub, PDF p.41).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Price/market-coordination argument does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Coercion argument** is associated with: on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without reliably satisfying genuine wants, even when it is intended to enlarge welfare (Gaub, PDF pp.42-43).
2. **Mark-weight cue (10/15)** is associated with: A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being (Gaub, PDF p.41).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Coercion argument does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **"Examine"/"Critically examine"** is associated with: A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gauba, PDF p.40).
2. **Authoritarian state** is associated with: A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gauba, PDF p.40).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with "Examine"/"Critically examine" does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **"Critically evaluate"** is associated with: Give a reasoned verdict on whether liberalism's economic program (classical vs welfare vs neoliberal) or its constitutional core (Section 9, Section 19 Unit 6) is its more defensible contribution.
2. **Classical / negative liberalism** is associated with: The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gauba, PDF p.41).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with "Critically evaluate" does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Mark-weight cue (10/15)** is associated with: The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gauba, PDF p.41).
2. **Welfare / positive liberalism** is associated with: Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Mark-weight cue (10/15) does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Liberalism always means anti-state politics.?**

- A. Gauba explicitly distinguishes classical negative liberalism from welfare positive liberalism (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).
- B. Neoliberalism is a contemporary restoration of laissez-faire within the wider liberal family (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).
- C. He also credits it with rationalism, critique of feudalism and durable constitutional values (Gauba, PDF pp.44-45).
- D. Gauba says liberalism's lasting value survives strongly as constitutionalism and limits on arbitrary power (Gauba, PDF p.45).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba explicitly distinguishes classical negative liberalism from welfare positive liberalism (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception: 'Neoliberalism and liberalism are identical.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception: 'Gauba's criticism means liberalism has no contribution.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception: 'Liberalism only protects property and has nothing to do with constitutionalism.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Liberalism always means anti-state politics, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Neoliberalism and liberalism are identical.**?

- A. Gauba explicitly distinguishes classical negative liberalism from welfare positive liberalism (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).
- B. Neoliberalism is a contemporary restoration of laissez-faire within the wider liberal family (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).
- C. He also credits it with rationalism, critique of feudalism and durable constitutional values (Gauba, PDF pp.44-45).
- D. Gauba says liberalism's lasting value survives strongly as constitutionalism and limits on arbitrary power (Gauba, PDF p.45).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception: 'Liberalism always means anti-state politics.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Neoliberalism is a contemporary restoration of laissez-faire within the wider liberal family (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception: 'Gauba's criticism means liberalism has no contribution.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception: 'Liberalism only protects property and has nothing to do with constitutionalism.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Neoliberalism and liberalism are identical, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Hayek, Friedman and Nozick defend one identical doctrine.**?

- A. Neoliberalism is a contemporary restoration of laissez-faire within the wider liberal family (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43); no additional distinction is made within this interpretation.
- B. Gauba says liberalism's lasting value survives strongly as constitutionalism and limits on arbitrary power (Gauba, PDF p.45); this option applies the proposition as a complete explanation.
- C. Hayek, Friedman and Nozick defend one identical doctrine. -> Gauba groups them for rollback purposes, but Hayekian spontaneous order, Friedmanite market freedom and Nozickian entitlement/minimal-state reasoning remain distinct arguments
- D. Gauba explicitly distinguishes classical negative liberalism from welfare positive liberalism (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42); the rival mechanism is treated as non-decisive in this account.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception: 'Neoliberalism and liberalism are identical.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception: 'Liberalism only protects property and has nothing to do with constitutionalism.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba groups them for rollback purposes, but Hayekian spontaneous order, Friedmanite market freedom and Nozickian entitlement/minimal-state reasoning remain distinct arguments.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception: 'Liberalism always means anti-state politics.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Hayek, Friedman and Nozick defend one identical, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Liberalism only protects property and has nothing to do with constitutionalism.**?

- A. He also credits it with rationalism, critique of feudalism and durable constitutional values (Gaubu, PDF pp.44-45).
- B. Gauba explicitly distinguishes classical negative liberalism from welfare positive liberalism (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42).
- C. Neoliberalism is a contemporary restoration of laissez-faire within the wider liberal family (Gaubu, PDF pp.42-43).
- D. Gauba says liberalism's lasting value survives strongly as constitutionalism and limits on arbitrary power (Gaubu, PDF p.45).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception: 'Gaubu's criticism means liberalism has no contribution.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception: 'Liberalism always means anti-state politics.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception: 'Neoliberalism and liberalism are identical.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba says liberalism's lasting value survives strongly as constitutionalism and limits on arbitrary power (Gaubu, PDF p.45).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Liberalism only protects property and has nothing to, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Welfare liberalism abandoned liberty.**?

- A. Its claim is that liberty needs supportive conditions, not merely absence of restraint (Gaubu, PDF p.41).
- B. Neoliberalism is a contemporary restoration of laissez-faire within the wider liberal family (Gaubu, PDF pp.42-43).
- C. He also credits it with rationalism, critique of feudalism and durable constitutional values (Gaubu, PDF pp.44-45).
- D. Gauba explicitly distinguishes classical negative liberalism from welfare positive liberalism (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Its claim is that liberty needs supportive conditions, not merely absence of restraint (Gaubu, PDF p.41).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception: 'Neoliberalism and liberalism are identical.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception: 'Gaubu's criticism means liberalism has no contribution.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception: 'Liberalism always means anti-state politics.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Welfare liberalism abandoned liberty, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Gauba's criticism means liberalism has no contribution.?**

- A. Neoliberalism is a contemporary restoration of laissez-faire within the wider liberal family (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).
- B. He also credits it with rationalism, critique of feudalism and durable constitutional values (Gauba, PDF pp.44-45).
- C. Gauba explicitly distinguishes classical negative liberalism from welfare positive liberalism (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).
- D. Gauba says liberalism's lasting value survives strongly as constitutionalism and limits on arbitrary power (Gauba, PDF p.45).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception: 'Neoliberalism and liberalism are identical.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: He also credits it with rationalism, critique of feudalism and durable constitutional values (Gauba, PDF pp.44-45).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception: 'Liberalism always means anti-state politics.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception: 'Liberalism only protects property and has nothing to do with constitutionalism.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Gauba's criticism means liberalism has no contribution, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Do not collapse liberalism into a single market slogan.?**

- A. Neoliberalism and liberalism are identical. -> Neoliberalism is a contemporary restoration of laissez-faire within the wider liberal family
- B. The chapter's whole point is that liberalism is internally divided on that question.
- C. Keep classical, welfare and neoliberal strands distinct.
- D. Welfare liberalism abandoned liberty. -> Its claim is that liberty needs supportive conditions, not merely absence of restraint

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception: 'Neoliberalism and liberalism are identical.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception: 'Do not portray all liberalism as anti-state or all state action as anti-liberal.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Keep classical, welfare and neoliberal strands distinct.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception: 'Welfare liberalism abandoned liberty.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Do not collapse liberalism into a single market slogan, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Do not portray all liberalism as anti-state or all state action as anti-liberal.**?

- A. Its claim is that liberty needs supportive conditions, not merely absence of restraint (Gaubas, PDF p.41).
- B. Neoliberalism and liberalism are identical. -> Neoliberalism is a contemporary restoration of laissez-faire within the wider liberal family
- C. Keep classical, welfare and neoliberal strands distinct.
- D. The chapter's whole point is that liberalism is internally divided on that question.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception: 'Welfare liberalism abandoned liberty.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception: 'Neoliberalism and liberalism are identical.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception: 'Do not collapse liberalism into a single market slogan.'; it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: The chapter's whole point is that liberalism is internally divided on that question.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Do not portray all liberalism as anti-state or all, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for **Liberalism and Neoliberalism** in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish classical liberalism, welfare liberalism and neoliberalism. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of classical liberalism, welfare liberalism and neoliberalism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Classical and Welfare, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: The liberal family is united by individual freedom and constitutional restraint, but divided over whether markets alone secure freedom or an enabling state must create its social conditions.

Model answer (140 words):

Introduction: The three strands share commitment to the individual, rights and constitutional restraint, but differ over the conditions required for effective freedom. Core analysis: Classical liberalism stresses negative liberty, private property, contract and a limited state that protects rights and market exchange. Welfare or positive liberalism argues that formal non-interference is insufficient where poverty, ill-health or unequal education prevent real agency; the state must create enabling social conditions. Neoliberalism reasserts market coordination against an established welfare state, using arguments about dispersed knowledge, incentives, coercion and excessive public power. Critical evaluation: The divisions are not absolute: all three retain constitutionalism, but they disagree sharply about whether public action secures or threatens liberty. Conclusion: The liberal family is united by individual freedom and

constitutional restraint, but divided over whether markets alone secure freedom or an enabling state must create its social conditions.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Classical and Welfare), converts that evidence into analysis of classical liberalism, welfare liberalism and neoliberalism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: The liberal family is united by individual freedom and constitutional restraint, but divided over whether markets alone secure freedom or an enabling state must create its social conditions. At 140 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Explain Hayek's knowledge argument against comprehensive economic planning. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive explain requires the answer to set out the concept, its mechanism and its consequences in a stated order. Fix the boundary of hayek's knowledge argument against comprehensive economic planning in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Hayek's, Core and No, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Hayek's strongest case is epistemic rather than merely anti-state: dispersed knowledge limits comprehensive planning, though it does not establish that every public intervention is coercive or irrational.

Model answer (148 words):

Introduction: Hayek's central objection to comprehensive planning is that the knowledge needed for social coordination is dispersed, local and often tacit. Core analysis: No central authority can continuously possess all information about changing preferences, scarcities and opportunities. Competitive prices condense these scattered signals and permit individuals to adjust without a single commanding mind. Planning that suppresses this process must substitute administrative allocation and increasingly coercive decisions because agreement on one comprehensive hierarchy of ends is absent. Hayek therefore links epistemic limits to spontaneous order and political liberty. Critical evaluation: The argument establishes a presumption against total planning, not against every public rule or welfare measure. Markets also depend on legal institutions, and externalities or unequal power may require collective correction. Conclusion: Hayek's strongest case is epistemic rather than merely anti-state: dispersed knowledge limits comprehensive planning, though it does not establish that every public intervention is coercive or irrational.

Why this earns marks: it obeys explain instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Hayek's, Core and No), converts that evidence into analysis of hayek's knowledge argument against comprehensive economic planning, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Hayek's strongest case is epistemic rather than merely anti-state: dispersed knowledge limits comprehensive planning, though it does not establish that every public intervention is coercive or irrational. At 148 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Critically examine Nozick's entitlement theory and minimal state. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive critically examine requires the answer to test the proposition against its strongest objection before giving a verdict. Fix the boundary of examine Nozick's entitlement theory and minimal state in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Nozick, Core and Nozick's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Nozick powerfully protects historical entitlement and individual rights, but rectification and unequal starting conditions prevent the theory from validating every existing distribution.

Model answer (138 words):

Introduction: Nozick judges holdings by their history rather than by whether the final distribution fits a preferred pattern. Core analysis: A holding is entitled when it arises through just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where injustice occurred, rectification. Since persons possess rights over themselves and legitimately acquired resources, patterned redistribution requires continuous interference with voluntary choices. The legitimate state is therefore minimal, limited to protection against force, theft and fraud and to enforcement of contracts. Nozick's position powerfully exposes the tension between distributive patterns and individual choice. Further development: The contrast with Rawls clarifies the dispute. The rectification principle is indispensable but underdeveloped, and existing holdings

cannot be presumed just merely because current transfers appear voluntary. Conclusion: Nozick powerfully protects historical entitlement and individual rights, but rectification and unequal starting conditions prevent the theory from validating every existing distribution.

Why this earns marks: it obeys critically examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Nozick, Core and Nozick's), converts that evidence into analysis of examine Nozick's entitlement theory and minimal state, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Nozick powerfully protects historical entitlement and individual rights, but rectification and unequal starting conditions prevent the theory from validating every existing distribution. At 138 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: How does welfare liberalism answer the classical liberal conception of freedom? Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive how requires the answer to state the mechanism step by step and show what each step produces. Fix the boundary of does welfare liberalism answer the classical liberal conception of freedom in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Welfare, Core and Thinkers, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that the answer remains liberal only if welfare measures protect equal citizenship, legal rights and plural choice rather than allowing an unlimited administrative state.

Model answer (222 words):

Introduction: Welfare liberalism accepts the liberal priority of freedom but rejects the assumption that freedom is exhausted by absence of legal restraint. Core analysis: Thinkers such as Green and Hobhouse argue that liberty requires the capacity to pursue worthwhile purposes. Laski and Tawney translate this moral insight into institutional claims: education, health, social security and regulation may be needed to prevent dependence and make citizenship effective. The enabling state is therefore justified not as a substitute for individual agency but as a condition of it. This distinguishes positive or substantive freedom from the thinner classical focus on contract and non-interference. Further development: The internal liberal debate is therefore about the source of unfreedom. Classical liberalism fears coercive law and concentrated public authority; welfare liberalism adds dependence produced by social and economic deprivation. Green and Hobhouse supply the moral account of enabling freedom, while Laski and Tawney support its institutional expression. The answer remains liberal only if welfare measures protect equal citizenship, legal rights and plural choice rather than allowing an unlimited administrative state. Critical evaluation: The welfare answer must still confront paternalism, fiscal burden and bureaucratic domination. Public action advances liberty only when it enlarges capabilities while remaining constitutionally accountable. Conclusion: Welfare liberalism preserves liberty while arguing that formal non-interference is inadequate where poverty, dependence and unequal capability make choice merely nominal.

Why this earns marks: it obeys how instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Welfare, Core and Thinkers), converts that evidence into analysis of does welfare liberalism answer the classical liberal conception of freedom, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that the answer remains liberal only if welfare measures protect equal citizenship, legal rights and plural choice rather than allowing an unlimited administrative state. At 222 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate neoliberalism as both a revival of classical liberalism and a response to the welfare state. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive evaluate requires the answer to apply a stated criterion and give a graded verdict, not a summary. Fix the boundary of neoliberalism as both a revival of classical liberalism and a response to the welfare state in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Neoliberalism, Core and Like, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Neoliberalism revives market liberty, but its distinctive historical target is an already developed welfare state;.

Model answer (236 words):

Introduction: Neoliberalism revives classical concerns about state power and market freedom, but it emerges in a different institutional setting. Core analysis: Like classical liberalism, it values private choice, competition, property and limited government. Unlike the original doctrine, it confronts a mature welfare and regulatory state and therefore seeks

rollback, privatisation, deregulation and renewed market discipline. Hayek supplies the knowledge and coercion arguments, Friedman emphasises market coordination, and Nozick offers a rights-based case for the minimal state. These arguments are related but not identical. Further development: Its three major arguments must remain distinct. Hayek stresses dispersed knowledge and spontaneous order; Friedman stresses market coordination and limits on discretionary government; Nozick stresses self-ownership and historical entitlement. Their convergence supports rollback, but their premises are not interchangeable. Critics respond that market outcomes reflect inherited power and that health, education and social security may enlarge rather than diminish freedom. Constitutional safeguards, competitive institutions and transparent regulation remain necessary even within a market-centred order. The resulting verdict should distinguish a justified presumption for decentralised choice from a dogmatic presumption that every public intervention fails. Critical evaluation: Neoliberalism correctly identifies information failures and the danger of concentrated public power, yet it can underestimate unequal market power, historical disadvantage and the public institutions on which markets depend. Conclusion: Neoliberalism revives market liberty, but its distinctive historical target is an already developed welfare state; it is therefore restoration under new conditions, not simple repetition.

Why this earns marks: it obeys evaluate instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Neoliberalism, Core and Like), converts that evidence into analysis of neoliberalism as both a revival of classical liberalism and a response to the welfare state, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Neoliberalism revives market liberty, but its distinctive historical target is an already developed welfare state;. At 236 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Compare the Hayekian, Nozickian and Rawlsian approaches to liberty, property and distributive justice. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of the Hayekian, Nozickian and Rawlsian approaches to liberty, property and distributive justice in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Hayek, Nozick and Rawls, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that each remains vulnerable where its preferred mechanism overlooks the others' concern.

Model answer (243 words):

Introduction: Hayek, Nozick and Rawls belong to the liberal family, but they justify institutions through different moral and analytical routes. Core analysis: Hayek defends spontaneous market order because dispersed knowledge cannot be comprehensively planned; he distrusts distributive designs that treat society as if one agent controlled all outcomes. Nozick begins with self-ownership and historical entitlement, limiting the state to protection and rectification. Rawls asks what principles free and equal persons would choose under fair conditions; equal basic liberties are combined with fair opportunity and the difference principle. Property is therefore constrained by justice as fairness rather than treated as presumptively inviolable. Further development: The comparison also yields different conceptions of coercion. Hayek fears purposive control of a spontaneous order; Nozick treats compulsory redistribution as a rights violation; Rawls asks whether the coercive basic structure could be justified to citizens as free and equal. Rawls therefore permits redistribution under public principles, Nozick permits only protection and rectification, and Hayek resists distributive language where no single agent designed the outcome. A balanced answer should preserve Hayek's knowledge problem, Nozick's historical test and Rawls's concern with fair background institutions. Critical evaluation: Hayek's epistemic caution and Nozick's rights protect liberty, while Rawls more directly addresses structural starting points. Each remains vulnerable where its preferred mechanism overlooks the others' concern. Conclusion: Hayek, Nozick and Rawls defend different moral routes from liberty to institutions, so no serious comparison can collapse spontaneous order, entitlement and fairness into one liberal position.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Hayek, Nozick and Rawls), converts that evidence into analysis of the Hayekian, Nozickian and Rawlsian approaches to liberty, property and distributive justice, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that each remains vulnerable where its preferred mechanism overlooks the others' concern. At 243 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.